



File No.: EXP202411328

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

Considering the complaint registered on July 17, 2024, with this Agency and the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: The complaining party exercised the right of Erasure against the respondent, and their request, as stated by the complaining party, did not receive the legally established response.

The complaining party provides various documents related to the complaint filed with this Agency and regarding the exercise of the right exercised.

SECOND: Once the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD was fulfilled, the complaint was admitted for processing, and the respondent entity was granted a hearing period, to present any arguments they deemed appropriate within ten working days.

The respondent entity has not demonstrated, during the formalized procedures, that it responded to the request for the exercise of rights presented by the complaining party.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued for its development, and, in so far as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

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2/5

II

Preliminary Issues

In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Agency for Data Protection is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including the enforcement of the Regulation and promoting awareness among data controllers and processors regarding their obligations, as well as addressing complaints filed by a data subject and investigating, as appropriate, the reasons for them.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of data controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In cases where they have appointed a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with that authority.

In accordance with this regulation, following the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, prior to the admission of the complaint regarding the exercise of the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, which gives rise to this procedure, it was forwarded to the respondent party for analysis, to respond to this Agency within one month and to demonstrate that they had provided the complainant with the appropriate response.

The result of this forwarding did not allow for the understanding that the claims of the complaining party were satisfied. Consequently, on October 17, 2024, for the purposes provided for in Articles 64.1 and 65 of the LOPDGDD, the complaint was admitted for processing. This admission for processing

determines the opening of the present procedure for the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, which states:

“When the procedure refers exclusively to the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of April 27, 2016, it will be initiated by an admission agreement, which will be adopted in accordance with the provisions of Article 65 of this organic law.

In this case, the deadline for resolving the procedure will be six months from the date on which the admission agreement was notified to the complainant. Once this period has elapsed, the interested party may consider their complaint accepted.”

Article 58.2 of the GDPR grants the Spanish Agency for Data Protection a series of corrective powers to correct any infringement of the GDPR, including “ordering the controller or processor to address the requests for the exercise of the rights of the data subject under this Regulation.”

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3/5

III

Rights of Individuals Regarding Personal Data Protection

The rights of individuals regarding personal data protection are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights include access, rectification, erasure, objection, the right to restriction of processing, and the right to data portability.

The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, consideration is given to what is expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR.

In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the data subject, which will be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless it can demonstrate that it is unable to identify the data subject, and to express its reasons in case it does not intend to comply with such request. The burden of proof regarding compliance with the duty to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party falls on the data controller.

The communication directed to the data subject regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

Regarding the right of access to personal data, according to what is established in Article 13 of the LOPDGDD, when the exercise of the right refers to a large amount of data, the data controller may request the affected party to specify the "data or processing activities to which the request refers." The right will be considered granted if the data controller provides remote access to the data, with the request being deemed addressed (although the data subject may request information regarding the aspects provided in Article 15 of the GDPR).

The exercise of this right may be considered repetitive more than once during a six-month period, unless there is a legitimate reason for it.

On the other hand, the request will be considered excessive when the affected party chooses a means other than the one offered that entails a disproportionate cost, which must be borne by the affected party.

IV

Conclusion

In the case analyzed here, the claiming party exercised their right to Erasure regulated in Article 17 of the GDPR and Article 15 of the LOPDGDD.

After the period established according to the aforementioned regulations, their request did not receive the legally required response. The entity being claimed has not addressed the request.

C/ Jorge Juan, 6

request of the claiming party nor the requirements that have been sent to it by this Agency.

The aforementioned rules do not allow the request to be overlooked as if it had not been made, leaving it without the response that those responsible must necessarily issue, even in the event that there are no data of the interested party in the entity's files or even in those cases where the requirements set forth are not met, in which case the recipient of such request is also obliged to require the correction of the observed deficiencies or, if applicable, to deny the request with justification indicating the reasons why the right in question cannot be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the responsible party to provide an express response, in any case, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

Given that a copy of the necessary communication that must be sent to the claimant informing them of the decision made regarding the exercise of rights request has not been provided, it is appropriate to uphold the complaint that initiated this procedure.

Having reviewed the cited provisions and others of general application, the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD the complaint filed by A.A.A. considering that the provisions of Article 17 of the GDPR have been infringed and to urge the TOWN HALL OF SIETE AGUAS, with NIF P4623100G, to send the claimant a certification within ten working days from the date this resolution becomes final and enforceable, addressing the right of Erasure exercised or denying it with justification indicating the reasons why the request cannot be attended to, in accordance with the provisions established in the body of this resolution. The actions taken as a result of this Resolution must be communicated to this Agency within the same period. Failure to comply with this resolution could result in the commission of an infringement of Article 83.6 of the GDPR, classified as very serious for the purposes of prescription in Article 72.1.m) of the LOPDGDD, which will be sanctioned in accordance with Article 58.2 of the GDPR.

SECOND: NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to the TOWN HALL OF SIETE AGUAS.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure (Article 18.4 of the LOPD), and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations, a voluntary appeal for reconsideration may be filed before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection, within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution, or a direct contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, C/ Jorge Juan, 6, www.aepd.es, 28001 – Madrid, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and Section 5 of the Fourth Additional Provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned legal text.

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